COLORADO MESH COMMUNITY

Colorado Mesh Monthly

October 2026

Your once-a-month digest of everything on the mesh — so you don't have to read every message.

Happy almost-Halloween, Colorado. October was the month the mesh started thinking hard about emergencies — a homegrown protocol for emergency comms (MECP), a push into TAK, and a volunteer emergency reporting network — all while Mesh Client shipped a monster V6, the map got a faster brain (say hello to Beacon), and wardrivers lit up everything from Durango to Buena Vista to the back roads off I-25. We've got more to cover than last month, so grab a warm drink and settle in. As always, it's sorted so you can jump straight to your corner of the mesh.

General News

- **Emergency communications took center stage.** A lot of this month's energy went toward making the mesh genuinely useful when it matters most — a new **MECP** (Mesh Emergency Communications Protocol) under active development, and a TAK bridge for situational awareness. The whole thread gets its own Story of the Month below, but it's the throughline of October.
- **Admin team changes.** The leadership team shared a round of updates this month. Several admins stepped down to focus on other priorities — **👀, Dani, strex, Slim, and littlecrab (KFØWBX)** — and we're grateful for everything they put in. Please join us in welcoming **Zeva** to the admin team. The Admin Team handles day-to-day Discord and website operations; together with the Regional Representatives they make up the broader org leadership.
- **One short link to rule them all.** Colorado Mesh now has a tidy set of short links on the `colome.sh` domain: `colome.sh/discord`, `colome.sh/wiki`, `colome.sh/start`, `colome.sh/mcmap` (MeshCore map) and `colome.sh/mtmap` (Meshtastic map), to name a few. Easier to share, easier to remember.
- **Mesh Client v6.0.0 is here** — and it's big enough that it gets its own section below. The short version: new UI, a new BLE implementation, continued Reticulum work, and a lot more.
- **The map got a new engine.** The MeshCore map and analyzer, formerly powered by CoreScope, has been replaced with **Beacon**, a faster, more-performant, purpose-built tool.
- **A new TAK corner of the community.** A dedicated TAK server role and `#tak` channel spun up this month as interest in ATAK integration took off (more in Gear & Firmware).
- **This very newsletter made its debut.** The first Colorado Mesh Monthly (our Aug/Sept catch-up) went live on the blog and the website — thank you for the genuinely warm reception. If you're reading issue two, you're part of the habit now.

Events & Meetups

- **A letter went to Rocky Mountain National Park.** JohnnyW5KV wrote to the park superintendent requesting permission to install a mesh repeater, making the case for backcountry communications infrastructure. No word back yet, but it's exactly the kind of ambitious ask that expands what the mesh can be. (#backcountry-general)
- **Wardriving keeps filling in the map.** It's an ongoing, year-round effort, and October was a productive stretch: Zeva ran a Grand Junction wardrive with MeshMapper and a weekend sweep that hit **#5 on the MeshMapper leaderboard**; wardrivers picked up fresh coverage along **I-25 and Highway 66**; and new observers lit up in **Durango** and **Buena Vista**. Got a car node? Every drive adds data — the map only gets better the more of us are out there.
- **Weekly Net — every Thursday, all day.** Quick reminder on the rules: a check-in is *any* message on the MeshCore Public channel between 12:00 a.m. and 11:59 p.m. on Thursday — not just the one-hour Discord event.

Photo / Video of the Month



*October's build of the month: **jk** modified a Wio Tracker L1 case and added a pogo-pin connector for easy, solder-free battery swaps. Exactly the kind of hands-on tinkering — print, tweak, improve, share — that keeps the mesh fun. Photo: jk, from #projects-and-builds.*

Meshtastic

- **Hold off on Meshtastic 2.8.** Multiple operators report that 2.8 releases are causing problems, including causing boot loops on Seeed Solar Nodes. If you're on 2.7 and stable, there's no rush to jump. (#meshtastic)
- **Firmware 3.0 is on the horizon — and it changes bandwidth allocations.** Meshtastic 3.0 will shift how bandwidth is allocated, with a default LongTurbo preset in the United States. That said, switching to LongTurbo right now isn't recommended due to performance drops.
- **MediumFast adoption is still the slow grind.** Some nodes in Denver are switching to MediumFast, as Colorado Mesh has recommended, but adoption remains slow since most people never change their default settings. This has caused a split between MediumFast and LongFast users. Preset defaults really do shape the whole network. If your area recommends MediumFast, the switch only pays off when neighbors make it too.
- **A clever idea: MediumFast as a backhaul.** Meanwhile, some have floated the idea of using MediumFast as an amplified point-to-point backhaul — super-long links between sites — with local breakouts onto LongFast.
- **The Lookout Mountain bridge is half-alive.** Zeva has a LongFast node and a Wi-Fi bridge up on Lookout Mountain; the goal is to bridge LongFast and MediumFast over serial and echo it all to MQTT. Not finished, but a real step toward tying the high-site plumbing together.
- **Commerce City feeder node is back online.** Live on-mesh Meshtastic data is being collected by a feeder node near the Rocky Mountain Arsenal and published to https://potato.meshtastic.coloradomesh.org. This provides a more holistic view of metro Denver and Fort Collins traffic, not just over-MQTT data.
- **Remote firmware from the mountain.** omgitsgela described a GL.iNet-router-over-ZeroTier setup that serves serial + firmware data to mountaintop nodes, so you can update and reconfigure without the climb. A good pattern for anything hard to reach.

MeshCore

- **CoreScope → Beacon.** The headline for MeshCore tooling this month: Colorado Mesh retired the CoreScope analyzer in favor of **Beacon**, a more efficient, purpose-built map. It lives at https://map.meshcore.coloradomesh.org (the old CoreScope link, https://analyzer.meshcore.coloradomesh.org, automatically redirects to Beacon). Beacon handles packet-ambiguity better than CoreScope, providing more accurate data about the local mesh.
- **Coverage keeps filling in.** The Buena Vista area popped up on the map with a half-dozen repeaters, a new Durango observer is tracking potential inter-state traffic with New Mexico, and wardrivers added I-25 and Highway 66. All repeaters in the area now support multibyte paths, even when their adverts still show single-byte — a real routing improvement.
- **A naming-convention experiment is spreading.** Chicago mesh users have begun trialing a "Chicagoland Naming Convention" that closely follows the Colorado Mesh schema. Nice to see our conventions getting adopted — and stress-tested — beyond state lines.
- **Should Colorado Mesh ship its own firmware?** Admins floated the idea that it might be time for a custom Colorado Mesh MeshCore firmware with enhanced features. An early conversation, but one worth watching.
- **Keep naming nodes to convention.** As the map fills, the repeater name tool keeps everything legible and, more importantly, helps avoid conflicting public keys.

Reticulum

- **Reticulum-over-MeshCore gets a working baseline.** Reticulum has been a first-class part of Mesh Client for a while now — the news this month is narrower and more technical: Zeva got a **Reticulum-on-MeshCore** baseline build working (WiFi clients on MeshCore are still failing, Meshtastic testing pending). It's early, but it's another transport combination coming together.
- **NomadNet keeps growing.** Zeva expanded their NomadNet interfaces and added saved-location storage (identifying nodes on connect), and shared the NomadNet-Pages repo for anyone building `.mu` pages: https://github.com/SebastianObi/NomadNet-Pages
- **On the dev bench.** Rin has been poking at Reticulum features — a possible fingerprint-button function, optional userid/password auth on sites — and sharing reference-doc thoughts for developers. The RRC hub remains an active gathering spot; it's still the easiest no-RF on-ramp to the whole hobby.

Gear & Firmware

A busy month at the workbench — new radios, new bridges, and a few "learn from my mistakes" notes:

- **TAK is the new frontier.** W0RMT released **meshcore-tak-bridge**, which connects a MeshCore companion node to ATAK for full messaging. It's moving fast: **v0.1.2** added direct-message delivery receipts and radio battery monitoring (on-screen percentage plus low-battery alerts at 20% and 10%), and **MECP decoding + map-marker placement now work** in the bridge. A dedicated `#tak` channel and server role appeared to house all of it.
- **A new radio to watch.** The **Radioddity Nodara Meshtastic radio** is out and slated for review (JohnnyW5KV) — product page: https://www.radioddity.com/products/radioddity-nodara-meshtastic-radio
- **RFOXiA — a long-range BLE module that meshes.** A new protocol is being added to Mesh Client to support the RFOXiA BLE module; the manufacturer is sending two units to enable it. Heads-up from Rin: the RFOXiA firmware has a **50-byte message limit** (a compile-time constant, not a BLE/radio limitation), and the docs don't quite match the code yet.
- **A quiet, cheap build tip.** beala released a custom MeshCore build that **disables the LED and buzzer** (great for a silent, low-power node) — https://github.com/beala/MeshCore/releases/tag/t1000e-v1.17.1
- **Still a crowd favorite: the RAK 1W.** JohnnyW5KV again gives the RAK 1W board a thumbs-up for its integrated input/output filters — "an awesome little board for the price." Zeva confirms a 3000 mAh battery pairs with the RAK 1W companion without issues.
- **Solar builds everywhere.** Darin built a first solar node from an ACE Hardware solar light; beala shared a custom LFP + LR2021-carrier charger; UtahSTI stood up a solar repeater (SenseCAP P1-Pro) in Hesperus bound for a rooftop with a 5.8 dBi antenna. Zeva's modular magnetic car-node design continues — there's a 1W low-profile solar car-node model on Printables.
- **Hardware gotcha.** Runr flagged SD-card issues in MuziWorks "batch 1" — the cards are replaceable and a new order has shipped, so check yours if you're on that batch.

Get the Mesh Client — now at V6

New here, or still juggling a different app per protocol? The community's free, cross-platform **Mesh Client** (Windows / macOS / Linux) speaks Meshtastic, MeshCore, *and* Reticulum from one window — and **version 6.0.0** just landed with a pile of upgrades. Highlights this cycle:

- A refreshed **user interface** and a new **BLE implementation** (with smarter handling when you've got multiple BLE radios of the same type — the UI now helps you tell which radio you're actually driving).
- **Reticulum support** maturing inside the client, plus ongoing work to decouple the backend from the UI and a clean-room `rnsgit`-in-Rust effort.
- Quality-of-life work on settings migrations and DB upgrades (hence the repeated "please test the next build" calls — thank you to everyone who did).
- A new **V6 walkthrough video**: https://youtu.be/iRu1FDME0-w

Huge thanks to **Joey (NV0N)**, lead developer, and the whole contributor crew — Zeva, Rin, cj, budt W0RMT and more. Grab it (and test builds) at github.com/Colorado-Mesh/mesh-client.

For Sale & Wanted

- No member classifieds came in this month. _Got gear to sell or a part you're hunting for? Drop it in the channel and we'll run it here next issue._

Call to Action

Lend a hand with emergency comms. This is the month's big ask. A few concrete ways in:

- **Help shape MECP.** The Mesh Emergency Communications Protocol is being designed *now*, and the team is actively looking for emergency communicators to help plan (omgitsgela, an emergency communicator, already jumped in). If you've got EmComm/ICS experience, your input is gold.
- **Build and place nodes where they matter.** omgitsgela is sourcing physical nodes for roughly **$20 each** to push coverage into mountain areas and highway corridors, and is looking for volunteers to build and deploy. High spots and dead corridors are exactly where a new node does the most good.

And the evergreen one: **run an observer in your area**, especially out past the metro. If your region looks empty on the map, it's usually just because nobody's reporting from there yet. The MeshCore MQTT guide walks you through it.

Community Spotlight

A few people who moved the mesh this month:

- **budt W0RMT** — a one-person TAK pipeline, shipping the meshcore-tak-bridge, wiring up MECP decoding, and synthesizing community discussion into real documentation.
- **Zeva** — everywhere again: Mesh Client V6, Reticulum integration, Dockerizing the client, a Grand Junction wardrive, a #5 MeshMapper finish, and a steady stream of hardware builds.
- **nwithan8** — Beacon, observer onboarding, and MQTT plumbing.
- **omgitsgela** — EmComm planning energy, the MediumFast-backhaul idea, and a plan to seed $20 nodes into the gaps.

And a warm welcome to everyone who built their first node this month — including **Darin**, whose first solar node came out of an ACE Hardware solar light. That's the spirit.

Around the Web

Beacon / MeshCore map — https://map.meshcore.coloradomesh.org

Mesh Client V6 walkthrough (video) — https://youtu.be/iRu1FDME0-w

Rettui (Reticulum TUI) — now with an Android release by Zeva — https://github.com/zevaryx/rettui/releases

MeshMapper app overview (how the mapping works) — https://wiki.meshmapper.net/app_overview/

meshcore-tak-bridge (MeshCore ↔ ATAK) — https://github.com/Colorado-Mesh/meshcore-tak-bridge

Colorado Mesh short links — https://colome.sh

Story of the Month: When the Mesh Grows Up — Emergency Comms

Every hobby network eventually faces the same question: *what is this actually for?* In October, Colorado Mesh started answering it out loud — and the answer kept coming back to emergencies.

The spark is a protocol. There's long been an awkward truth in the mesh world, and Rin said it plainly this month: there are **no real EMCOMM standards for LoRa mesh networks**. The established emergency framework, ICS, assumes infrastructure a mesh simply can't provide. So the community started building its own — **MECP**, the Mesh Emergency Communications Protocol — a structured way to move emergency information over LoRa mesh. It's early and the message volume is already enough that Rin asked for a summary doc just to keep up, but the pieces are moving fast: budt W0RMT already has **MECP decoding and map-marker placement working** inside the meshcore-tak-bridge, which pipes mesh traffic into **ATAK**, the situational-awareness tool a lot of EmComm and SAR folks already live in.

Around that protocol, an ecosystem is forming. omgitsgela — an actual emergency communicator — stepped up to help plan, and is sourcing ~$20 nodes to push coverage into the mountains and highway corridors where cell service dies and a mesh would matter most.

What's striking isn't any single feature — it's the shift in *posture*. A network that spent the summer celebrating its first cross-state-line packet is now asking how it performs on the worst day, not the best one. That's a community growing into its purpose. If you've got ICS or EmComm experience, or just a good high spot and a soldering iron, this is the moment your contribution counts double. The mesh is deciding what it wants to be when it grows up. Come help decide.

Until Next Month

That's October — a big one. The mesh is reaching for high spots, new protocols, and a real role in emergencies, and it's all powered by people deciding their corner of Colorado belongs on the map. Lit up a repeater? Printed an enclosure? Ran a killer wardrive? Have EmComm experience to lend? Tell us — it lands in the next issue. Big or small, we want it.

😄 **Nerd Joke of the Month:** Why did the MeshCore repeater refuse to panic in an emergency? It knew help was only a few hops away.

🎁 **The Prize:** congratulations to **jfh200** 🎉 — our winner this month, drawn at random from everyone who reacted to last month's newsletter announcement in Discord! This month's prize: an **Alfa N-type antenna** paired with an **N-type cable** — a solid upgrade for anyone looking to get a repeater or base node heard farther. Want in next month? **React to this issue's announcement post** and you're entered.

73 📻

Sources & Further Reading

1. Join / getting started — https://colome.sh/start
2. Website - https://colome.sh
3. Discord - https://colome.sh/discord
4. MeshCore live map — https://colome.sh/mcmap
5. Meshtastic live map — https://colome.sh/mtmap
6. MeshCore config tools — https://colome.sh/mctools
7. Run a MeshCore observer — https://colome.sh/mcmqtt
8. Mesh Client — https://colome.sh/client
9. MeshCore Weekly Net check-in — https://colome.sh/mcnet
10. Donate to keep the network running — https://colome.sh/donate